# ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Many kind people went out of their way to help me in a variety of ways during my researches and in my writing. So protracted has this process been, with so many stops and starts, and so forgetful have I become over the last few years that some names that should appear here have either been lost or simply forgotten. My humblest apologies to those so unwittingly omitted, along with my thanks. This will include a great many local enthusiasts, amateurs and professionals alike, who share that same spirit of enquiry that drove the first Orientalists.

Toby Sinclair took the time to read my manuscript at an early stage, William Dalrymple, David Loyn and John Bynner each read sections, and all made invaluable suggestions. Dr Cameron Petrie was kind enough to make valuable comments and corrections arising from his work on the Harappan Civilisation. However, my greatest debt here is to two first-rate historians, Professor Emeritus Kesavan Veluthat, late of the Department of History at the University of Delhi, and Dr Crispin Branfoot, Reader in the History of South Asian Art and Archaeology at the School of Oriental and African Studies in London. Both were good enough to go through my manuscript at a late stage and take the time to make numerous suggestions and, indeed, corrections of fact. I am enormously grateful to both of them for bringing their scholarship to bear on my work and for saving me from making a complete ass of myself. I have done my best to answer their criticisms and concerns, but the responsibility